

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Media and Entertainment English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For producers, production managers, creative executives, rights coordinators, distribution teams, talent managers, marketing staff, and media operations professionals.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Creative Briefs and Development Notes

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Production Planning and Budget

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

03 Rights, Clearances, and Licensing

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

04 Talent, Contracts, and Approvals

Clarify missing information before responding.

05 Distribution and Windowing

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

06 Audience Metrics and Performance

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

07 Sponsorship, Brand Safety, and Integration

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

08 Crisis Response and Public Statements

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Creative Briefs and Development Notes

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A client asks for a video to feel "premium and energetic." The team has no examples, audience definition, or delivery requirements.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

creative brief - A document defining the audience, objective, message, and requirements for creative work.

tone - The attitude or level of formality conveyed by wording and delivery.

brand fit - How well an activity or message matches a brand's identity and intended audience.

deliverable - A specified item of work to be provided to a customer or project recipient.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - B. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - C. Could you confirm when starts the review?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - B. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - C. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

What does premium sound like?

The producer clarifies the lesson's incomplete video brief with the client creative lead; audience and delivery requirements remain unknown.

01 • Producer: Your creative brief says premium and energetic. Which qualities should viewers actually notice in the video?

02 • Client creative lead: I haven't selected examples yet. I realize those words leave considerable room for interpretation.

03 • Producer: Would you like to discuss the audience first, before we propose music or an editing rhythm?

04 • Client creative lead: Yes, although I still need our marketing team to confirm who the primary audience is.

05 • Producer: Then I will mark the audience as unresolved. Who can clarify the intended deliverable and channels?

06 • Client creative lead: Our campaign manager can answer that. Are those details necessary before you explore the tone?

07 • Producer: We can explore possibilities, but we cannot assess brand fit confidently without that context.

08 • Client creative lead: Please show alternatives as discussion material, not as an agreed creative direction.

09 • Producer: Understood. Could you arrange a briefing with the campaign manager and bring two reference examples?

10 • Client creative lead: I'll request that meeting and confirm availability. The creative direction remains open until we clarify those points.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A trailer or a complete story?

Separate fictional case: a museum commissions a thirty-second exhibit trailer for its lobby screen, without specifying whether it should include narration.

01 • Creative director: The brief calls this a documentary, but the deliverable is a thirty-second lobby trailer.

02 • Museum communications lead: We want visitors to understand the exhibit. Is documentary the wrong word for that?

03 • Creative director: It suggests a fuller story. Should this piece explain the exhibit or encourage people to enter?

04 • Museum communications lead: Encourage them to enter. We can leave the detailed explanation to the exhibit itself.

05 • Creative director: That helps define the tone. Should we develop a visual invitation rather than a narrated summary?

06 • Museum communications lead: Possibly, but I haven't checked whether sound is available on that screen.

07 • Creative director: Could you confirm that before we build a concept around a voice-over?

08 • Museum communications lead: Yes. Meanwhile, can you explore a version that communicates through images and short captions?

09 • Creative director: Certainly. I'll label sound as unconfirmed and focus the creative brief on attracting visitors.

10 • Museum communications lead: Good. I'll check the screen setup, then review the concept for accuracy and brand fit.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Two meanings of playful

Separate fictional case: a podcast producer and a commissioning editor discuss a gardening series for first-time apartment gardeners; the brief requests a playful tone.

01 • Podcast producer: When you ask for a playful tone, do you mean comedy or an approachable conversation?

02 • Commissioning editor: An approachable conversation. The listeners are first-time apartment gardeners, and we shouldn't make mistakes embarrassing.

03 • Podcast producer: So practical curiosity would fit better than jokes about people who cannot keep plants alive?

04 • Commissioning editor: Exactly. The brand fit depends on welcoming beginners, not presenting the host as superior.

05 • Podcast producer: Could we use a host who asks the questions a new gardener might hesitate to ask?

06 • Commissioning editor: Yes, provided the expert answers respectfully. What would you bring to the development review?

07 • Podcast producer: A sample opening and an episode outline, unless you expect a fully recorded pilot.

08 • Commissioning editor: An outline is sufficient. Please don't book talent or studio time for this review.

09 • Podcast producer: Then the deliverable is an outline with a sample opening, and no production booking.

10 • Commissioning editor: Correct. That gives us enough to test the tone before deciding whether to commission a pilot.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Creative Briefs and Development Notes

A client asks for a video to feel "premium and energetic." The team has no examples, audience definition, or delivery requirements.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Could you share a reference and explain which qualities you want to capture? Let's also confirm the audience and deliverables so the creative direction can be discussed concretely.

Scenario 2 | Which version belongs on the screen?

In a fictional cinema campaign, the client requests one poster animation for both a silent foyer screen and an online placement with sound. Only the foyer dimensions are supplied. Hold a clarification call and agree what must be confirmed before production.

Role A: You are the motion producer. Clarify whether one deliverable or two adapted versions are expected.

Role B: You are the campaign coordinator. You know the foyer is silent but must obtain the online specifications.

Possible opening: Before we estimate the animation, could you clarify whether you need separate versions for the two placements?

Success checks

- Clarify the deliverables and sound requirements separately.
- Keep the online specifications explicitly unresolved.
- Agree who will obtain the missing specifications before production is scheduled.

Add a complication: The client calls the online version a simple resize, although its dimensions and duration remain unknown.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Production Planning and Budget

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

A production schedule adds a location change, but transport time and the budget have not been revised.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

production budget - The planned costs of making a media project or carrying out production work.

call sheet - A production document listing who is needed, where, and when for a shoot.

location - A specified place where work, filming, an event, or service occurs.

permit - Official permission for an activity under specified requirements.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Compare this wording: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team is completing the review.
 - B. The team plans to complete the review.
 - C. The team has completed the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.
 - B. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.
 - C. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The move is not yet scheduled

A production manager updates a producer on the lesson's added location change; transport time and the production budget are still unrevised.

01 • Producer: The schedule now includes the second location. Can I tell the client the move is fully planned?

02 • Production manager: The location change is listed, but transport time and the production budget have not been revised.

03 • Producer: So the shooting blocks are visible, but the travel between them is still missing?

04 • Production manager: Correct. The current schedule should not be treated as a workable final call sheet.

05 • Producer: What needs to happen before we can give the crew reliable arrival times?

06 • Production manager: We need a transport estimate and a review of how the move affects the shooting day.

07 • Producer: Does adding the location also mean that any required access or permit is confirmed?

08 • Production manager: No. Listing a location does not establish its access status; that needs a separate check.

09 • Producer: I'll describe the plan as provisional and avoid promising that the original budget still holds.

10 • Production manager: I'll coordinate the outstanding checks and return with their scheduling and cost implications.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Rain cover remains an option

Separate fictional case: a commercial shoot has a confirmed outdoor booking; an indoor rain-cover quote is available but has not been accepted.

01 • Line producer: The outdoor booking is confirmed. The indoor rain-cover location is only quoted, not reserved.

02 • Agency producer: The client saw both addresses on the schedule and thought we had secured both spaces.

03 • Line producer: I should distinguish their status more clearly. The indoor option still needs a booking decision.

04 • Agency producer: Can you put the indoor address on the call sheet now, just in case?

05 • Line producer: Not as a confirmed reporting location. That could send crew to a space we haven't booked.

06 • Agency producer: What can we tell the client about the production budget without overstating progress?

07 • Line producer: The main location is booked; the rain-cover cost is quoted and awaits approval.

08 • Agency producer: Please also explain what is excluded from the confirmed arrangement, rather than saying everything is covered.

09 • Line producer: Agreed. I'll keep the contingency separate and ask the location manager about the option's availability.

10 • Agency producer: I'll take the cost question to the client and report the decision before we change crew instructions.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The revised call sheet has not reached everyone

Separate fictional case: a studio shoot's revised call sheet changes the makeup call to seven; camera crew receipts are confirmed, but makeup receipt is not.

01 • Production coordinator: The revised call sheet is out, and camera has confirmed receipt. Makeup's acknowledgment is still missing.

02 • Assistant director: Then everyone knows about the seven o'clock makeup call, apart from that final confirmation?

03 • Production coordinator: We know it was sent, not that makeup has seen it. Those are different states.

04 • Assistant director: You're right. The earlier sheet could still be the version they are using.

05 • Production coordinator: I'll contact the makeup lead directly and ask them to repeat the updated call time.

06 • Assistant director: Please check whether that earlier call changes their booked hours or the production budget.

07 • Production coordinator: I can ask, but I don't have confirmation of an additional charge at this point.

08 • Assistant director: Keep that cost as pending rather than assuming the revised schedule has no effect.

09 • Production coordinator: My update will separate distribution, acknowledgment, and any cost adjustment that needs approval.

10 • Assistant director: Good. Let me know when makeup confirms so I can settle the opening setup with the crew.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Production Planning and Budget

A production schedule adds a location change, but transport time and the budget have not been revised.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The location change adds work that is not reflected in the current schedule or budget. I'll identify the transport and setup implications for review before we confirm the revised plan.

Scenario 2 | A vehicle booking with no driver confirmation

In a fictional documentary shoot, a vehicle reservation is confirmed for Tuesday, but the supplier has not confirmed a driver. Equipment collection depends on that vehicle. Give a production status update and agree the next check.

Role A: You are the transport coordinator. Explain the confirmed reservation and the outstanding driver assignment.

Role B: You are the production manager. Ask what this means for equipment collection and the call sheet.

Possible opening: The vehicle is reserved for Tuesday, but we still need confirmation of the driver.

Success checks

- Distinguish a vehicle reservation from a confirmed transport arrangement.
- Explain the dependency without inventing a delay.
- Agree who will contact the supplier and update production.

Add a complication: A colleague wants the call sheet to describe transport as fully confirmed.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Rights, Clearances, and Licensing

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

A draft video includes music with unclear licensing documentation. The planned channels and territories are known.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

rights - Permissions or entitlements concerning the use of property, content, or other protected interests.

clearance - Formal permission or confirmation that a required review has been completed; the meaning depends on the task.

license - Permission to use specified rights, material, or a product under stated conditions.

territory - The geographic area covered by specified commercial or media rights.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
 - B. Send it no later than Thursday.
 - C. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - B. Could you confirm that the review is important?
 - C. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Find the music license before release

The lesson's draft video uses music with unclear licensing documentation; the planned channels and territories are already recorded.

01 • Post-production producer: Could you locate the music license so the rights team can compare it with our distribution plan?

02 • Music supervisor: I can search the project records. Do you need the audio file or the licensing documentation?

03 • Post-production producer: The documentation, including the track identifier. We already know the planned channels and territories.

04 • Music supervisor: Would a purchase receipt be enough to clear the track for release?

05 • Post-production producer: I can't establish that. The rights reviewer needs to assess what the available documents actually cover.

06 • Music supervisor: Understood. I'll send the documents through the project folder and flag anything I cannot locate.

07 • Post-production producer: Could you also tell me when that search can be completed, rather than guessing a clearance date?

08 • Music supervisor: Yes. I can confirm the search timing after I check where the original purchase was recorded.

09 • Post-production producer: Until review is complete, I'll keep the music clearance marked unresolved in the release checklist.

10 • Music supervisor: I'll return with the records or a precise account of what remains missing.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An archive clip needs a new use review

Separate fictional case: a studio holds documentation for an archive clip in an internal training film and now proposes a public festival trailer.

01 • Archive producer: Please review the archive clip's rights for the proposed festival trailer; its existing documentation describes internal training.

02 • Clearance coordinator: Could you provide the exact clip reference and the proposed trailer use together?

03 • Archive producer: Yes. I'll send those with the existing license so you can compare the intended uses.

04 • Clearance coordinator: Do you already have confirmation that the public trailer falls within the existing grant?

05 • Archive producer: No. That's the point we need checked before treating the clip as cleared.

06 • Clearance coordinator: Then I may need to contact the rights holder after reviewing the wording.

07 • Archive producer: Please tell me whether that is necessary and what additional information they request.

08 • Clearance coordinator: I can start the document review today, but I cannot promise when an external response will arrive.

09 • Archive producer: That works. I'll keep an alternative edit available without presenting it as a cleared replacement.

10 • Clearance coordinator: I'll report the review status and any remaining permissions question before you lock the trailer.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A still image without a source trail

Separate fictional case: a magazine's digital teaser includes a historical photograph copied from a research deck; the original source and permission status are unknown.

01 • Digital editor: Could you trace the photograph in slide eight? We need its source before the teaser goes forward.

02 • Research producer: The research deck is where I found it, but that doesn't identify the original rights holder.

03 • Digital editor: Exactly. Please check the research notes rather than treating the deck as a license.

04 • Research producer: Should I ask design to remove the image while I investigate its clearance status?

05 • Digital editor: Ask them to prepare a version without it. We haven't established whether the proposed use is permitted.

06 • Research producer: What information should I bring back beyond a website link or the photographer's name?

07 • Digital editor: The source trail and any permission records, so our rights reviewer can assess the proposed digital use.

08 • Research producer: I can report what I find at our afternoon check-in; missing records may take longer.

09 • Digital editor: Please separate records found from conclusions about rights. We'll need review before making a release decision.

10 • Research producer: Understood. I'll trace the image and keep design informed without claiming the clearance is complete.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Rights, Clearances, and Licensing

A draft video includes music with unclear licensing documentation. The planned channels and territories are known.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could the rights team confirm that the license covers the planned channels and territories? I'll provide the intended use and asset details so the clearance question can be reviewed before publication.

Scenario 2 | A licensed excerpt in a longer cut

A fictional educational film has a documented license for a twenty-second excerpt. A proposed new cut uses thirty seconds. The effect of that change has not been reviewed. Discuss the request for rights review, not the legal answer.

Role A: You are the editor. Supply the old and proposed durations and request a review before picture lock.

Role B: You are the clearance producer. Ask for the license and both timecoded excerpts, and discuss when you can respond.

Possible opening: Could you review whether our proposed thirty-second excerpt is covered before we lock this new cut?

Success checks

- State both durations without assuming permission.
- Request the license and timecoded material for a defined review.
- Agree a status check without promising an external clearance date.

Add a complication: The director says ten extra seconds cannot matter and asks you to skip the review.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Talent, Contracts, and Approvals

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A talent agreement includes an approval step, but the production calendar does not show who submits material or when.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

talent agreement - A contract describing a performer's services, rights, compensation, and relevant conditions.

approval right - A contractual right to review and accept or reject specified material or actions.

likeness - A person's recognizable image or appearance, often relevant to publicity and licensing rights.

release - Authorization to make a product available or proceed to a next stage, depending on the field.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - B. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - C. Could you confirm when starts the review?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - B. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - C. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Who sends the talent approval package?

The lesson's talent agreement includes an approval step, but the calendar omits the submission owner and timing.

01 • Production coordinator: The talent agreement includes an approval step. Who is responsible for submitting the material?

02 • Talent liaison: The calendar doesn't identify that person, so I cannot confirm who owns the submission.

03 • Production coordinator: Could you help establish the owner before we add a review milestone to the schedule?

04 • Talent liaison: Yes. We should also clarify what material the approval right covers rather than sending everything automatically.

05 • Production coordinator: Does the current calendar say when the reviewer needs to receive the package?

06 • Talent liaison: No. Submission timing is missing too, and I don't want to invent a turnaround period.

07 • Production coordinator: Then should we ask the agreement owner to confirm scope, submission contact, and timing?

08 • Talent liaison: Exactly. My role in communicating with talent doesn't itself resolve those contractual details.

09 • Production coordinator: I'll record the unanswered questions and keep the release milestone conditional on the required approvals.

10 • Talent liaison: Once the agreement owner responds, let's read back the responsibilities together before updating the calendar.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Which photograph did the agent approve?

Separate fictional case: an agent's email approves portrait file P4; a publicity folder contains P4 and a differently cropped file P4-square.

01 • Publicity producer: The agent approved P4. Does that also cover the square crop in our publicity folder?

02 • Talent coordinator: The email names P4 only. I can't assume it includes the separately labeled square version.

03 • Publicity producer: Could you clarify whether the approval concerns this exact image treatment or the underlying photograph?

04 • Talent coordinator: I'll ask using both filenames and thumbnails, so the question is specific.

05 • Publicity producer: We should avoid describing the talent's likeness as fully approved across every promotional asset, then?

06 • Talent coordinator: Correct. We have an approval for a named file, not a blanket statement about all assets.

07 • Publicity producer: Would it help if I identify which placement needs the square crop?

08 • Talent coordinator: Yes. Include that intended use so the reviewer knows what we are asking them to consider.

09 • Publicity producer: I'll keep the square asset pending and send a clear comparison without altering either file.

10 • Talent coordinator: I'll seek clarification and attach the response to the exact version before publicity proceeds.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A signed release is not a recorded review

Separate fictional case: a training-video project has a signed contributor release and a project checklist with an unfilled interview-review item; the item's purpose is unclear.

01 • Post-production coordinator: The contributor release is signed, but the interview-review box is blank. What does that review mean here?

02 • Producer: I don't know whether it concerns factual accuracy or an approval right. The label is unclear.

03 • Post-production coordinator: Could we check the agreed arrangement before treating the signed release as completion of both steps?

04 • Producer: Yes. Those records may answer different questions, and we shouldn't merge them without checking.

05 • Post-production coordinator: Who can clarify the purpose of the review item and who is expected to respond?

06 • Producer: I'll ask the colleague who created the checklist and compare their explanation with the project agreement.

07 • Post-production coordinator: Should the editor send the interview directly to the contributor in the meantime?

08 • Producer: Let's first confirm the submission process and material required. An unnecessary send could create more confusion.

09 • Post-production coordinator: I'll leave the review item open and label the signed release separately in the tracker.

10 • Producer: Good. We'll confirm what remains required before telling the editor that the interview can be finalized.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Talent, Contracts, and Approvals

A talent agreement includes an approval step, but the production calendar does not show who submits material or when.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Who submits the material for approval, what is being reviewed, and what timing does the agreement specify? Let's put those responsibilities into the production schedule.

Scenario 2 | Audio approval with no named version

A fictional audiobook project's approval message says the sample is fine. Two samples were sent: a narration-only file and a version with music. No filename is named in the reply. Clarify which version was approved before giving the studio instructions.

Role A: You are the studio coordinator. Identify the ambiguity and ask for version-specific confirmation.

Role B: You are the talent liaison. You have the reply but no further information about its scope.

Possible opening: Could you confirm whether the approval refers to the narration-only sample or the version with music?

Success checks

- Name the two versions distinctly.
- Avoid treating the reply as approval of both versions.
- Agree who will obtain and relay the specific confirmation.

Add a complication: The studio wants to book final mixing based on the ambiguous reply.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Distribution and Windowing

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

SITUATION

Two distribution proposals offer different exclusivity periods and territories. A summary compares only the fee.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

windowing - Planning when and where media content is made available across distribution channels.

exclusivity - An arrangement limiting specified rights or activities to one party for an agreed scope.

platform - A foundational technology or system that supports several applications or products.

rights window - The period during which specified distribution or use rights apply.

3. Notice the language

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Compare this wording: This option is more better.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Explain a fair comparison

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence expresses a clear contrast?
 - A. Option A is faster because option B costs less.
 - B. Option A is faster, so option B costs less.
 - C. Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.
2. A rate increases from 6% to 7%. What is the absolute difference?
 - A. An increase of seven percentage points.
 - B. An increase of one percentage point.
 - C. An increase of one percent relative to the original rate.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Compare what the fee buys

The lesson's distribution proposals differ in exclusivity and territory, but their summary shows only fees; exact terms are not supplied here.

01 • Sales agent: The fee comparison makes one distribution proposal look stronger, but the rights packages are different.

02 • Producer: Which differences should I hear before deciding whether the higher fee is more attractive?

03 • Sales agent: We need to compare territories, exclusivity periods, and the rights window alongside the fee.

04 • Producer: Could a larger payment mean giving up opportunities on other platforms for longer?

05 • Sales agent: It could, depending on the actual exclusivity terms. The summary doesn't show enough to assess that.

06 • Producer: Then calling one offer better value now would hide a tradeoff we haven't examined.

07 • Sales agent: Exactly. Both proposals need to appear against the same criteria, even where their terms differ.

08 • Producer: Please include which future distribution choices each proposal might limit, subject to the agreement review.

09 • Sales agent: I'll request a complete comparison and flag any windowing details that remain unclear.

10 • Producer: We'll discuss the fees with those conditions visible, rather than treating unlike rights packages as equivalent.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A short exclusive window or a longer nonexclusive run

Separate fictional case: a short film receives two offers for the same territory: six months exclusive at 8,000 units or twelve months nonexclusive at 6,000 units; other terms remain unreviewed.

01 • Distribution manager: Both offers cover the same territory. One pays eight thousand for six months of exclusivity.

02 • Film producer: The other pays six thousand for twelve months without exclusivity. Does the shorter window clearly win?

03 • Distribution manager: It pays more, but exclusivity may limit parallel placements during those six months.

04 • Film producer: Whereas the nonexclusive proposal preserves more placement flexibility, although the fee is lower?

05 • Distribution manager: That is the stated distinction. We still need to review the remaining rights terms.

06 • Film producer: Could we simply double the six-month fee to compare an annual figure?

07 • Distribution manager: No. That would assume an identical second deal exists after the first rights window closes.

08 • Film producer: Then show the actual payments and durations, not an invented annual earnings forecast.

09 • Distribution manager: I'll also identify how each proposal fits our intended windowing sequence, with unresolved terms marked.

10 • Film producer: Good. We'll weigh flexibility against the larger guaranteed fee only after that review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Download access versus festival access

Separate fictional case: a documentary team compares two proposed first releases: a paid download platform with no minimum guarantee and a festival package with a fixed screening fee; both have unconfirmed later-window restrictions.

01 • Documentary producer: The download platform offers wider access, while the festival package includes a fixed screening fee.

02 • Distribution adviser: Those are different benefits. Which criteria matter most for the first rights window?

03 • Documentary producer: Audience access and predictable income. We should consider both, rather than comparing only projected sales.

04 • Distribution adviser: Agreed. The download proposal has no minimum guarantee, so projected revenue is not a confirmed payment.

05 • Documentary producer: And the festival fee is fixed, but that doesn't tell us how many people will attend.

06 • Distribution adviser: Exactly. We also haven't confirmed either proposal's restrictions on later platform distribution.

07 • Documentary producer: Would it be premature to promise a download release immediately after the festival screenings?

08 • Distribution adviser: Yes. We need the windowing conditions before presenting that sequence as available.

09 • Documentary producer: Let's compare access, payment certainty, and later-window flexibility with the missing terms clearly identified.

10 • Distribution adviser: I'll obtain those terms, then we can discuss the tradeoff without turning estimates into guarantees.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Distribution and Windowing

Two distribution proposals offer different exclusivity periods and territories. A summary compares only the fee.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: The fee is only one difference. We should compare the rights window, territory, exclusivity, and other terms before describing one proposal as more valuable.

Scenario 2 | One territory or three?

For a fictional series, offer A pays 12,000 units for one territory and offer B pays 18,000 for three territories. Both run for one year and are nonexclusive. Translation costs and delivery requirements are unknown. Compare the offers without assuming identical net income.

Role A: You are the producer. Ask what the wider territory offer requires and explain your preferred comparison criteria.

Role B: You are the distribution manager. State known terms and identify the missing costs and deliverables.

Possible opening: Both offers run for one year, but the higher fee covers three territories rather than one.

Success checks

- Compare duration, scope, and fees on a consistent basis.
- Explain why territory counts alone do not establish value.
- Identify delivery and translation questions before recommending an offer.

Add a complication: A colleague divides each fee by territory and declares the lower total offer automatically superior.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Audience Metrics and Performance

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A campaign video reaches more viewers but has a lower completion rate. A report labels it an unqualified success.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

reach - The number of distinct people or accounts exposed to content under a stated measurement method.

completion rate - The proportion of started or eligible activities that reach a defined end point.

retention - Keeping customers, users, staff, or records over a stated period; specify which meaning applies.

audience segment - A subgroup of an audience sharing relevant characteristics or needs.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - B. The change may have contributed to the delay.
 - C. The change must have caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - B. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...
 - C. Across the service, the observed result was ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Wider reach, weaker completion

An audience analyst challenges the lesson's unqualified success claim: campaign reach increased while completion rate declined.

01 • Campaign manager: The report calls the video an unqualified success because it reached more viewers this time.

02 • Audience analyst: Reach increased, but completion rate declined. Both observations belong in the performance summary.

03 • Campaign manager: Does the lower completion rate prove that the creative became less engaging?

04 • Audience analyst: No. We haven't established the cause or checked whether the audience segment mix changed.

05 • Campaign manager: Then how can we explain the result without making the report sound indecisive?

06 • Audience analyst: State the wider reach and lower completion clearly, then identify what we still need to investigate.

07 • Campaign manager: Could retention by segment help us see where people stopped watching?

08 • Audience analyst: It could help describe viewing patterns, provided we use comparable definitions and time periods.

09 • Campaign manager: I'll remove the blanket success label and connect each measure to the campaign's intended objective.

10 • Audience analyst: I'll examine the segment data and keep explanations provisional until the evidence supports them.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The cliff at the opening titles

Separate fictional case: a streaming episode's retention chart drops at the opening-title sequence; no comparison with earlier episodes or device types has been made.

01 • Showrunner: The retention curve drops at the opening titles. Should we conclude viewers dislike the music?

02 • Audience researcher: The chart shows when viewing falls, but it doesn't tell us why people leave.

03 • Showrunner: So the timing is observed, while the explanation about music is still a hypothesis?

04 • Audience researcher: Exactly. We haven't compared other episodes or checked whether the pattern differs by device.

05 • Showrunner: Could a playback problem produce a similar drop without reflecting audience preference?

06 • Audience researcher: That's a possible alternative, not a confirmed issue. We can ask the platform team to check.

07 • Showrunner: I want a useful development note, not a claim that the opening has failed creatively.

08 • Audience researcher: Then say we observed a drop during the titles and are investigating audience and playback patterns.

09 • Showrunner: I'll keep any proposed edit separate from the finding and avoid blaming the composer.

10 • Audience researcher: I'll return with comparable retention evidence so we can discuss whether a test edit is warranted.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A higher percentage from a smaller group

Separate fictional case: two teaser tests use different invited audiences; A has 80 completions from 100 starts and B has 45 from 50 starts.

01 • Marketing producer: Teaser B has a ninety percent completion rate, so it must work better for everyone.

02 • Research analyst: B had forty-five completions from fifty starts. A had eighty from one hundred starts.

03 • Marketing producer: That is ninety percent versus eighty percent. Isn't that enough to choose the stronger creative?

04 • Research analyst: It describes these tests, but the invited audiences differed. We haven't isolated the creative's effect.

05 • Marketing producer: So B's higher rate doesn't establish that the same audience would prefer it?

06 • Research analyst: Correct. Also, A recorded more completed views in absolute numbers because its test group was larger.

07 • Marketing producer: Let's report both counts and rates instead of using whichever measure favors our preferred version.

08 • Research analyst: Agreed. We can propose a comparison with consistent audience selection before making a broad recommendation.

09 • Marketing producer: I'll describe B as having the higher observed completion rate in its test group.

10 • Research analyst: And I'll keep audience differences visible, rather than labeling that result a universal creative advantage.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Audience Metrics and Performance

A campaign video reaches more viewers but has a lower completion rate. A report labels it an unqualified success.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: Reach increased, while completion rate declined. I'll relate each measure to the campaign objective and avoid treating one headline number as the full performance story.

Scenario 2 | Shares without sentiment

A fictional interview clip receives twice as many shares as the previous clip over the same seven-day period. Comments have not been reviewed, and the audience sizes differ. Discuss what the producer can responsibly say about audience response.

Role A: You are the audience analyst. Separate the share count from sentiment and comparable engagement rates.

Role B: You are the executive producer. Challenge whether the increase proves viewers liked the interview.

Possible opening: Shares increased, but we haven't established whether people are sharing the clip positively or critically.

Success checks

- State the observed share increase and measurement period.
- Keep sentiment and audience-adjusted comparisons unresolved.
- Agree which evidence to review before using a preference claim.

Add a complication: The promotional team wants to call it the audience's favorite interview.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Sponsorship, Brand Safety, and Integration

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

SITUATION

A sponsor requests an additional product mention after the integration plan has been agreed.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

brand safety - Measures intended to prevent advertising from appearing in unsuitable or harmful contexts.

product placement - Inclusion of a brand or product within media content under an agreed arrangement.

deliverable - A specified item of work to be provided to a customer or project recipient.

makegood - A replacement delivery or benefit offered to address an unmet advertising or sponsorship commitment.

3. Notice the language

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

We can ..., provided that

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm

Compare this wording: If you will approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Offer a workable tradeoff

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence presents a normal future condition clearly?
 - A. If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.
 - B. If the scope will change, we will review the schedule.
 - C. If the scope changes, we reviewed the schedule.
2. Which response negotiates a new request without silently promising extra work?
 - A. We have included it, although its scope has not been reviewed.
 - B. We guarantee the original date without assessing the addition.
 - C. We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An extra mention changes the integration

The lesson's sponsor requests another product mention after the integration plan has been agreed; no extra fee or schedule flexibility is established.

01 • Sponsor manager: Could you add another product mention? We would like more visibility than the agreed integration provides.

02 • Branded-content producer: We can discuss it, but an additional mention changes the deliverable we planned together.

03 • Sponsor manager: Would repeating the existing line avoid any meaningful change to the production work?

04 • Branded-content producer: Not necessarily. We need to assess pacing, recording requirements, and brand safety before confirming that.

05 • Sponsor manager: What alternatives could you explore without promising a new version immediately?

06 • Branded-content producer: We could review replacing an existing mention or assess the work needed for an additional one.

07 • Sponsor manager: Please compare those options. Our preference is more visibility, but we haven't approved extra expenditure.

08 • Branded-content producer: Understood. Any added scope would need agreement on cost and timing before production proceeds.

09 • Sponsor manager: And let's not call this a makegood; we haven't established a missed contractual deliverable.

10 • Branded-content producer: Agreed. I'll bring a scoped change proposal and keep the current integration plan in place meanwhile.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A sponsor category conflicts with a segment

Separate fictional case: a fictional podcast sponsor sells sleep products, while a planned comedy segment mocks sleep-tracking gadgets; the approved integration has not yet been recorded.

01 • Partnership producer: The planned gadget segment may raise a brand safety concern for our sleep-product sponsor.

02 • Editorial producer: I can review the transition, but I don't want sponsorship to silently dictate the editorial discussion.

03 • Partnership producer: Could we separate the product placement from that segment instead of changing the editorial point?

04 • Editorial producer: Possibly. We need to compare that with the agreed placement and preserve a clear sponsor disclosure.

05 • Partnership producer: Would you consider moving the integration to another break, subject to the sponsor's agreement?

06 • Editorial producer: Yes, provided the timing works and nobody presents it as already approved by either side.

07 • Partnership producer: I'll ask whether the alternate break meets their needs without promising an additional mention.

08 • Editorial producer: And I'll check the episode structure. We may need another discussion if the move disrupts pacing.

09 • Partnership producer: Then the proposal is a placement change, not extra editorial control or an expanded deliverable.

10 • Editorial producer: Correct. We'll confirm the revised arrangement only after both production and partnership checks are complete.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Choose a makegood that can actually run

Separate fictional case: a sponsor's contracted newsletter mention was omitted. The publisher proposes either a mention in next week's edition or one in a themed edition next month; neither is yet accepted.

01 • Account manager: We missed the newsletter mention and need to agree a makegood that addresses the omitted deliverable.

02 • Sponsor representative: Could you place it in both editions to compensate for the disruption to our campaign?

03 • Account manager: I can bring that request for approval, but the current options cover one replacement mention.

04 • Sponsor representative: Next week is sooner, whereas the themed edition next month fits our product more closely.

05 • Account manager: Exactly. We can discuss timing and context without guaranteeing a particular audience response.

06 • Sponsor representative: If we choose next month, can you confirm the precise placement before we accept?

07 • Account manager: I'll check available placement and return with the proposed deliverable. It isn't reserved yet.

08 • Sponsor representative: Please include the publication date and copy-review arrangements so the replacement is unambiguous.

09 • Account manager: Agreed. I'll seek those confirmations and your acceptance before calling the makegood settled.

10 • Sponsor representative: That works. We'll weigh the later but more relevant context against the earlier campaign exposure.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Sponsorship, Brand Safety, and Integration

A sponsor requests an additional product mention after the integration plan has been agreed.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

Second round: The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Model for scenario 1: We can review the request against the agreed deliverables and editorial requirements. Could we clarify the exact change and its implications before confirming that it is included?

Scenario 2 | A live mention becomes a recorded clip

A fictional sponsor has agreed to one live webinar mention. The sponsor now requests a separate promotional clip using that mention. Editing effort, talent permissions, and price have not been assessed. Discuss a conditional change proposal.

Role A: You are the sponsorship producer. Explain the additional deliverable and ask which clip use the sponsor needs.

Role B: You are the sponsor's campaign lead. Seek a useful alternative if a separate clip cannot be confirmed yet.

Possible opening: We can assess a separate clip, but it isn't included in the agreed live mention.

Success checks

- Separate the existing mention from the proposed new deliverable.
- Identify scope, permissions, and scheduling checks without giving legal conclusions.
- Agree a conditional proposal rather than an unsupported commitment.

Add a complication: The sponsor asks for a guaranteed delivery date before the review is complete.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Crisis Response and Public Statements

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A draft public statement gives an explanation for a production incident while facts are still being verified.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

public statement - A message issued by an organization for a public audience.

backlash - A strong negative reaction from an audience or group.

legal review - Examination of an issue or document by the appropriate legal professional.

holding statement - An initial public message stating verified information while further facts are being established.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change must have caused the delay.
 - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - C. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Remove the unverified explanation

A communications lead reviews the lesson's draft public statement about a production incident while facts are still being verified.

01 • Communications lead: The draft public statement explains why the production incident happened. Has that explanation been verified?

02 • Production spokesperson: Not yet. The team is still checking the facts, so that sentence goes beyond the evidence.

03 • Communications lead: Could we use a holding statement that acknowledges the incident without assigning a cause?

04 • Production spokesperson: Yes. We should separate what has been confirmed from what remains under review.

05 • Communications lead: The team worries that acknowledging uncertainty will make the statement seem evasive during the backlash.

06 • Production spokesperson: An unsupported explanation would create another problem. We can be direct about the limits of our information.

07 • Communications lead: Should we promise a full account tomorrow to make the holding statement more reassuring?

08 • Production spokesperson: Only if that timing is established. We don't currently have a verified completion date for the review.

09 • Communications lead: I'll remove the causal claim and submit the factual wording through the communications and legal review process.

10 • Production spokesperson: I'll check each operational claim and keep the next update tied to verified information.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A circulating clip is not the full recording

Separate fictional case: a shortened rehearsal clip is circulating online; the production team has the full recording but has not yet compared the two versions.

01 • Press officer: People are criticizing the rehearsal clip. Can we say it was deliberately edited to mislead viewers?

02 • Production researcher: We haven't compared it with the full recording yet, so we can't establish that claim.

03 • Press officer: We do know the circulating clip is shorter. Isn't that enough to call it misleading?

04 • Production researcher: It establishes that material is omitted, not the editor's intention or the effect of the omissions.

05 • Press officer: Then our holding statement should avoid attributing motive to the person who shared it.

06 • Production researcher: Yes. We can say we're reviewing the footage, if that review has actually begun.

07 • Press officer: I'll ask the authorized team to start the comparison before describing it as underway.

08 • Production researcher: Please also keep individual names out of the draft unless their inclusion has been reviewed.

09 • Press officer: I'll prepare restrained wording and seek approval, without promising that the full recording exonerates anyone.

10 • Production researcher: I'll provide a comparison of the actual content, with any uncertainty about context clearly noted.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A cancelled screening and an unknown cause

Separate fictional case: a screening was cancelled after a projector stopped working; the venue has not established whether the fault was equipment, power, or another cause.

01 • Festival communications manager: Our draft says the venue failed to maintain its projector. Do we have evidence for that?

02 • Venue operations lead: No. We know the projector stopped working and the screening was cancelled; the cause remains unknown.

03 • Festival communications manager: I will remove the maintenance allegation. Can we still acknowledge the inconvenience to ticket holders?

04 • Venue operations lead: Certainly. Acknowledging their disrupted evening doesn't require us to speculate about the technical fault.

05 • Festival communications manager: People are asking about another screening. Is a replacement date already confirmed?

06 • Venue operations lead: Not yet. We should distinguish exploring another screening from announcing a scheduled replacement.

07 • Festival communications manager: Then the public statement can state the cancellation and say scheduling information is not yet confirmed.

08 • Venue operations lead: Yes. Route any claims about remedies through the responsible ticketing team before publishing them.

09 • Festival communications manager: I'll use verified facts and avoid assigning blame while we obtain the operational and ticketing updates.

10 • Venue operations lead: I'll provide the confirmed information as it becomes available, with the unresolved cause kept explicit.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Crisis Response and Public Statements

A draft public statement gives an explanation for a production incident while facts are still being verified.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: We should state only what has been confirmed, acknowledge the concern, and explain the next information step. The proposed cause is still unverified and needs appropriate review before inclusion.

Scenario 2 | An account post nobody recognizes

A fictional studio's social account displayed an unexpected post that has now been removed. The team has not established whether it came from an authorized user, a scheduling error, or unauthorized access. Discuss a holding statement with no premature security diagnosis.

Role A: You are the communications manager. State only the observed post and its removal.

Role B: You are the account operations lead. Explain the unresolved cause and the need for authorized review.

Possible opening: The post has been removed, but we have not established how it was published.

Success checks

- Separate the observed event from possible causes.
- Avoid naming a culprit or confirming unauthorized access without evidence.
- Agree the operational verification and statement review needed before publication.

Add a complication: A senior colleague asks you to announce that the account was hacked.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Creative Briefs and Development Notes

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: A - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

B: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

C: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

Check 2: C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

B: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

C: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

Model response: Could you share a reference and explain which qualities you want to capture? Let's also confirm the audience and deliverables so the creative direction can be discussed concretely.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Production Planning and Budget

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: C - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

B: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

C: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

Check 2: B - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

B: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

C: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

Model response: The location change adds work that is not reflected in the current schedule or budget. I'll identify the transport and setup implications for review before we confirm the revised plan.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Rights, Clearances, and Licensing

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: B - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

B: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

C: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

Check 2: A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: The requested action and information are explicit.

B: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

C: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

Model response: Could the rights team confirm that the license covers the planned channels and territories? I'll provide the intended use and asset details so the clearance question can be reviewed before publication.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Talent, Contracts, and Approvals

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: A - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

B: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

C: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

Check 2: C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

B: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

C: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

Model response: Who submits the material for approval, what is being reviewed, and what timing does the agreement specify? Let's put those responsibilities into the production schedule.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Distribution and Windowing

Editing example: This option is better on cost, but slower to deliver.

'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Check 1: C - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.

A: 'Because' claims a causal connection that is not given.

B: 'So' implies one fact causes the other.

C: 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.

Check 2: B - An increase of one percentage point.

A: The new rate is 7%; the difference between the rates is one percentage point.

B: Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

C: A one-percent relative increase on 6% would be 6.06%, not 7%.

Model response: The fee is only one difference. We should compare the rights window, territory, exclusivity, and other terms before describing one proposal as more valuable.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Audience Metrics and Performance

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: B - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

B: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

C: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

Check 2: A - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

B: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

C: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

Model response: Reach increased, while completion rate declined. I'll relate each measure to the campaign objective and avoid treating one headline number as the full performance story.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Sponsorship, Brand Safety, and Integration

Editing example: If you approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

For an ordinary future condition, the "if" clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

Check 1: A - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.

A: The "if" clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.

B: For this ordinary future condition, use present simple in the "if" clause.

C: "Reviewed" places the response in the past instead of expressing the future response.

Check 2: C - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

A: It treats unreviewed work as already included.

B: It promises an outcome without examining the consequences.

C: This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

Model response: We can review the request against the agreed deliverables and editorial requirements. Could we clarify the exact change and its implications before confirming that it is included?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Crisis Response and Public Statements

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

Model response: We should state only what has been confirmed, acknowledge the concern, and explain the next information step. The proposed cause is still unverified and needs appropriate review before inclusion.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Media and Entertainment English

Professional audience: producers, production managers, creative executives, rights coordinators, distribution teams, talent managers, marketing staff, and media operations professionals

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Creative Briefs and Development Notes

Original fictional case: A client asks for a video to feel "premium and energetic." The team has no examples, audience definition, or delivery requirements.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: creative brief: A document defining the audience, objective, message, and requirements for creative work. / tone: The attitude or level of formality conveyed by wording and delivery. / brand fit: How well an activity or message matches a brand's identity and intended audience. / deliverable: A specified item of work to be provided to a customer or project recipient.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Could you share a reference and explain which qualities you want to capture? Let's also confirm the audience and deliverables so the creative direction can be discussed concretely.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Get feedback on a draft

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

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When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

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Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

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Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Could you share a reference and explain which qualities you want to capture? Let's also confirm the audience and deliverables so the creative direction can be discussed concretely.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Coach my workplace writing

1. Ask me to paste my own fictional or anonymized draft and identify its reader and purpose. If the reference gives a writing task, mention that task as the default. If it is a dialogue, suggest a brief follow-up message that records its outcome and open questions. Stop and wait. Do not write the message for me first.
2. Once I supply the draft, check it against the reference. If an ambiguity changes the meaning, ask one focused question before rewriting. Do not assume that the draft is correct evidence for a new deadline, approval, diagnosis, cost or commitment.
3. Give feedback in three parts: one effective phrase with a reason; up to three priority improvements, quoting my words; and one short revision task for me. Prioritize incorrect facts or unclear action before minor grammar. For each language correction, explain why it matters to this reader. Label optional stylistic alternatives separately and preserve my level of certainty and intended politeness.
4. Stop and wait for my revision. Then compare the two attempts, identify an improvement and offer one edited version that preserves my voice and purpose. Keep the requested length; if none is specified, use 70-110 words. Explain any meaningful change rather than silently making the message stronger or more certain.
5. Close with one phrase worth reusing and a short transfer task for a different fictional reader. Wait for my attempt before providing another model.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level